INCH-POUND

MIL-S-44385
22 November 1989

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SUIT, PARACHUTISTS, ROUGH TERRAIN

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a two piece Suit, Parachutists, Rough Terrain.

1.2 Classification. The suit shall be in the following sizes, as specified (see 6.2).

Schedule of sizes

Small
Medium
Large
X-Large

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8415

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

A-A-50083	-	Bag, Plastic, Folded Garment
V-F-106	-	Fastener, Slide, Interlocking
DDD-L-20	-	Label: for Clothing, Equipage and Tentage, (General Use)
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-C-508	-	Cloth, Oxford, Nylon, 3 Ounce
MIL-W-4088	-	Webbing, Textile, Woven Nylon
MIL-T-5038	-	Tape, Textile and Webbing, Textile, Reinforced Nylon
MIL-C-5040	-	Cord, Fibrous, Nylon
MIL-W-5664	-	Webbing, Textile, Elastic
MIL-G-16491	-	Grommet, Metallic
MIL-W-17337	-	Webbing, Textile, Woven Nylon
MIL-F-21840	-	Fastener Tapes, Hook and Loop, Synthetic
MIL-L-35078	-	Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For
MIL-C-43204	-	Cloth, Spacer, (Olefin)
MIL-T-43636	-	Thread, Aramid
MIL-W-43668	-	Webbing, Textile, Bulked Nylon
MIL-T-44100	-	Thread, Para-Aramid, Spun, Intermediate Modulus
MIL-C-44396	-	Cloth, Twill, Para-Aramid
MIL-C-87076	-	Cloth, Coated, Aramid, Aluminized
MIL-T-87128	-	Thread, Para-Aramid

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-751	-	Stitches, Seams and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147	-	Palletized Unit Loads
MIL-STD-731	-	Quality of Wood Members for Containers and Pallets

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specification, standards, and handbooks are available from the Naval Publications and Forms Center, (ATTN: NPODS), 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099.)

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2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

DRAWINGS

U.S. ARMY NATICK RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT, AND ENGINEERING CENTER

5-10-47 - Fastener, 1-Inch

(Copies of drawings are available from the U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, ATTN: STRNC-EMSS, Natick, MA 01760-5014.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF TEXTILE CHEMISTS AND COLORISTS (AATCC)

Chromatic Transference Scale

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists, P.O.Box 12215, Research Triangle Park, NC 27709-2215.)

THE COLOR ASSOCIATION OF THE UNITED STATES

Standard Color Card of America

Department of Defense Standard Color Card for Sewing Threads

(Application for color cards should be addressed to the Color Association of the United States, 343 Lexington Avenue, New York, NY 10016-0927. If color cards are not available from the Color Association, individual color samples may be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

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2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.3) in accordance with 4.3.

3.2 Samples. Samples, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the contractor (see 6.4). Variation from this specification may appear in the sample, in which case this specification shall govern.

3.3 Materials. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of this specification.

3.3.1 Basic fabric. The basic fabric shall be twill, para-aramid conforming to MIL-C-44396 and the color shall match the standard sample.

3.3.2 Pocket padding material. The fabric for the chambers which contain the padding shall conform to type I, class 2 or 3, Olive Green 106 of MIL-C-508.

3.3.3 Padding material. The padding material shall be 1/2 inch thick Plastazote or equal and shall have an average transfer force of no more than 410 G's when acting over a 10 millisecond period when tested as specified in 4.4.1.2.

3.3.4 Collar spacer material. The spacer material for inside the collar shall be type III conforming to MIL-C-43204.

3.3.5 Tape, nylon. The tape for covering the collar/neck seam shall be natural, 9/16 inch conforming to MIL-T-5038.

3.3.6 Cord, nylon. The closure cord for the leg pockets and the hardware pull thong shall be Olive Green 106 conforming to type III of MIL-C-5040.

3.3.7 Webbing, nylon. The webbing for the stirrups, legs,and crotch shall be 1 inch wide, Olive Drab 107, conforming to type XVIII, class 1 or 1A, of MIL-W-4088.

3.3.8 Webbing, nylon. The webbing for the leg strap tunnels and the stirrup buckle reinforcement piece shall be 1-23/32 inches wide, Olive Drab 107, conforming to type VIII of MIL-W-4088.

3.3.9 Webbing, nylon. The webbing for the suspenders, suspender buckle strap, suspender slide buckle strap and seat strap ends reinforcements shall be 1-1/2 inches wide, Olive Drab 107, conforming to class 2 of MIL-W-17337.

3.3.10 Webbing, bulked nylon. The webbing for the seat strap, seat strap ring reinforcements, pocket reinforcements, crotch strap and crotch strap guide piece, and stirrup buckle strap shall be 1 inch wide, Olive Drab 7 conforming to type III of MIL-W-43668.

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3.3.11 Webbing, elastic. The elastic webbing for connecting the nylon webbing of the suspenders shall be 1-1/2 inch, class 2, Olive Drab 107 conforming to MIL-W-5664.

3.3.12 Labels. Each jacket and trouser shall have a class 1 identification label, and a class 2 size label conforming to type VI of DDD-L-20. The labels shall be Medium Green Cable No. 70034, 70130 or 70131 and the colorfastness to laundering shall apply.

3.3.13 Thread, aramid and para-aramid. The thread for stitching and seaming shall be size B conforming to MIL-T-87128, size T-90 conforming to MIL-T-44100, or size 3 conforming to MIL-T-43636. The thread shall be Olive Drab S-1, C.A. 66022, and shall show fastness to laundering equal to or better than the standard sample. When no standard sample is available, the thread shall show "good" fastness to laundering.

3.3.14 Fastener, hook and loop. The hook and loop fastener tape for wrist closures shall be 1 inch wide, Olive Green 106, conforming to type I, class 1 of MIL-F-21840.

3.3.15 Fastener, slide. The left slide fastener for the jacket and the left and right slide fasteners for the trousers shall be Olive Drab 107, conforming to type IV, style 3, size H, with stirrup pull and thong, of V-F-106, except that the cross-wise breaking strength shall be a minimum of 160 pounds. The slide fasteners shall be in the following lengths in inches for the respective sizes:

	Jacket	Trousers
Small	27-1/2	50
Medium	28	50
Large	28-1/2	50
X-Large	29	50

3.3.16 Grommet, metallic. The grommet for the leg pocket closure cord shall be size No. 0 for the center grommet and size No. 00 for the left and right grommets conforming to type III, class 1 of MIL-G-16491.

3.3.17 Cord closure. The two hardware cord closures for the leg pockets shall conform to ITW NEXUS Co. Progresco B-LOK (B-LOK-2L) or equal.

3.3.18 Buckle, quick release. The two leg strap quick release buckles shall be a 1 inch ITW Nexus Model (SLL) Superloc or equal.

3.3.19 Buckle, suspender adjusting. The two suspender adjusting buckles shall be a 1-1/2 inch ITW Nexus Looploc or equal.

3.3.20 Buckle suspender elastic slide. The suspender elastic slide buckle shall be a 1-1/2 inch ITW Nexus Triglide (TG) or equal.

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3.3.21 Ring let down. The two let down rings on the seat straps shall be 1-3/4 inch inside diameter Forge Craft Co., No. 5010 O ring or equal.

3.3.22 Spine protector. The spine protector shall be made of 1/10 inch thickness of high density plastic 5 by 24 inches with corners rounded.

3.4 Design. The suit shall consist of a jacket and trousers. The jacket has a large stand-up protective collar, front slide fastener closure, padded shoulders, elbows, and back, and a stiff spine protector. The trousers have two front slide fastener closures, drawcord pockets, knee, back, and crotch padding, stirrups with adjusters, suspender straps, and drop attaching rings.

3.5 Patterns. Standard patterns which provide a seam allowance of 1/2 inch for all double lapped, double stitched seams, and 3/8 inch for all other seams unless otherwise specified, will be furnished by the Government. The Government patterns shall not be altered in any way and are to be used only as a guide for cutting the contractor's working patterns. The working patterns shall be identical to the Government patterns.

3.5.1 Pattern parts. The components of the suit shall be cut from the material as specified and in accordance with the number of parts indicated in table I.

TABLE I. List of pattern parts

Material	Nomenclature	Cut parts
Cloth, aramid	Jacket back	1
	Jacket front	2
	Sleeve	2
	Collar	2
	Leg	2
	Cargo pocket	2
	Crotch extension	1
	Spine pocket	1
	Tab	4
Cloth, Nylon	Elbow padding pocket	2
	Shoulder padding pocket	2
	Back padding pocket (A)	1
	Back padding pocket (B)	1
	Crotch padding pocket	2
	Knee padding pocket	2
	Seat padding pocket (A)	1
	Seat padding pocket (B)	1

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TABLE I. List of pattern parts (cont'd)

Material	Nomenclature	Cut parts
Padding	Elbow padding	2
	Shoulder padding	2
	Crotch padding	1
	Knee padding	2
	Seat padding	1
	Back padding	1
Cloth, olefin	Collar spacer	1
Plastic, high density	Spine protector	1
Webbing	Stirrup/crotch strap marker	1
	Seat strap marker	1

3.6 Construction. The construction shall conform in all respects to the requirements specified in table II and herein.

3.6.1 Stitches, seams and stitching. All stitches, seams, and stitching shall conform to FED-STD-751. The type of seam, stitching, and stitches per inch shall be as specified in table II. Seam allowances shall be maintained with seams sewn so that no raw edges, run-offs, pleats, puckers, or open seams occur. When two or more methods of seams or or stitches are given for the same operation, any one may be used.

3.6.1.1 Type 301 stitching. Ends of all stitching shall be backstitched or overstitched not less than 1/2 inch except where ends are turned under or caught in other seams or stitching. Thread tensions shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching resulting in loose bobbin or top thread, or excessively tight stitching resulting in puckering of the materials sewn. The lock shall be embedded in the materials sewn.

3.6.1.1.1 Repairs of type 301 stitching. Repairs of type 301 stitching shall be as follows:

a. When thread breaks or bobbin run-out occur during stitching, the stitching shall be repaired by restarting the stitching a minimum of 1/2 inch back of the end of the stitching. 1/

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b. Thread breaks or two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches noted during inspection of the item shall be repaired by overstitching. The stitching shall start a minimum of 1/2 inch in back of the defective area, and continue a minimum of 1/2 inch beyond the defective area on to the existing stitching. Loose or excessively tight stitching shall be repaired by removing the defective stitching without damaging the materials and restitching in the required manner. When damaged thread has been removed needle holes do not constitute damage to the material. 1/

1/ When making the above repairs the ends of the stitching are not required to be backstitched.

3.6.1.2 Type 502, 504, and 505 stitching. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching, or excessively tight stitching resulting in puckering of the materials sewn. All repairs shall be in accordance with 3.6.1.1.1a and b.

3.6.1.3 Bartacks. Unless otherwise specified, all bartacks shall be 3/4 ± 1/16 inch long and 1/8 ± 1/32 inch wide, and shall contain 42 stitches. Bartacking shall be free from thread breaks and loose stitching.

3.6.1.4 Automatic stitching. Automatic machines may be used to perform any of the stitch patterns provided the requirements for the stitch patterns, stitches per inch, and size and type of thread are met; and at least three tying, overlapping, or backstitches are used to secure the ends of stitches.

3.6.1.5 Thread ends. All thread ends shall be trimmed to 1/4 inch maximum length.

3.7 Manufacturing operation requirements. The suit shall be manufactured in accordance with operations requirements specified in table II. The contractor is not required to follow the exact sequence of operations. The contractor may pre-stitch the seam allowances for padding pockets for ease of attaching.

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TABLE II.

NO.	MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
1.	Cutting. a. The suits shall be cut in strict accordance with the patterns furnished which show size, placement of pockets, straps, and notches for proper assembly of all parts. b. Cut an 8 inch strip of 1-1/2 inch wide elastic webbing for connecting the suspenders. c. Cut and mark a 1 inch wide stirrup/crotch strap in accordance with applicable marker pattern for each size. d. Cut the 1 inch wide seat strap in accordance with applicable marker pattern for each size. e. Cut four pieces of nylon cord 16 to 16-1/2 inches in length for pocket drawcord and two pieces approximately 4 inches in length for thongs. f. Cut two 1-1/2 inch wide suspender straps 32 to 33 inches in length, two suspender buckle straps 5 to 5-1/2 inches in length, one suspender slide buckle strap 11-1/2 to 12 inches in length, and two seat strap end reinforcements 5-1/2 to 6 inches in length. g. Cut two 1 inch wide seat strap ring reinforcement pieces 7-3/4 to 8-1/4 in length, four cargo pocket reinforcements 1-1/2 to 2 inches in length, one crotch padding strap 7-3/4 to 8-1/4 inches in length, and one crotch padding strap guide 2-1/2 to 3 inches in length. h. Cut all padding according to patterns. NOTE: Cut c thru g with a hot wire.						

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TABLE II. (cont'd)

NO.	MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
2.	Shade and size marking. a. Mark, ticket, or bundle all component parts of the suit, except those cut from ends, to ensure uniform shade and size throughout the suit. b. Any method of marking may be used except: (1) Metal fastening devices (2) Sew-on type tickets (3) Adhesive type tickets which leave traces of paper or adhesive on the material after removal of the tickets. c. The use of an ink pad numbering machine, rubber stamp or pencil will be acceptable provided the numbers do not show through to the outside of the suit.						
3.	Replacement of defective or damaged parts. During the spreading, cutting, and manufacturing process, components having material defects or damages that are classified as defects in 4.4.2 shall be removed from production and replaced with non-defective and properly matched components.						

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TABLE II. (cont'd)

NO.	MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
4.	Assemble wrist tabs.						
	a. With face sides together, seam sides and point. Turn face side out, pushing out point, and raise stitch 1/8 to 3/16 inch from sewn edges.	301	SSe-2(a-b)	10-12	B	B	
	b. Position 2 1/2 ± 1/4 inches of hook fastener tape to each wrist tab beginning at start of point and stitch on all four sides 1/32 to 1/16 inch from edge.	301	LSbj-1	10-12	B	B	
5.	Assemble collar.						
	a. With face sides together seam ends and outer edge of collar. Turn face side out, pushing out points, and raise stitch 1/8 to 3/16 inch from sewn edges.	301	SSe-2(a-b)	10-12	B	B	
	b. Insert collar spacer and stitch across neck opening as close to spacer as possible.	301	SSa-1	10-12	B	B	
6.	Hem padding pockets.						
	Turn hem allowance to the inside of each padding pocket per marks on patterns and stitch 3/8 to 1/4 inch from folded edge.	301	EFa-2	10-12	B	B	
7.	Assemble sleeves.						
	a. Position the elbow padding pockets to the inside of the sleeves per marks on patterns with the pre-hemmed edge towards the wrists. Turn seam allowance under for the two sides not pre-hemmed or sewn in the underarm seam, and stitch around the three sides not hemmed 1/16 to 1/8 inch from edge (tack 1/2 to 1/4 inch across each end of the hemmed side).	301	LSd-2	10-12	B	B	

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TABLE II. (cont'd)

NO.	MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
7.	Assemble sleeves. (cont'd)						
	b. Position 4-1/2 to 5 inches of loop fastener tape to the face side of each sleeve per marks on patterns and stitch on all four sides 1/16 to 1/8 inch from edge.	301	LSbj-1	10-12	B	B	
	c. Position wrist tabs to the face side of each sleeve per marks on patterns (hook tape up and tab pointing away from loop tape) and stitch across tabs tacking ends.	301	LSb1-2(a)	10-12	B	B	
	d. Turn tab towards loop tape and stitch 1/8 to 1/4 inch from edge tacking ends.	301	LSb1-2(b)	10-12	B	B	
8.	Assemble trouser pockets.						
	a. Overedge stitch around each trouser pocket.	502, 504, or 505	EFd-1	10-12	B	B	
	b. Fold cargo pocket to itself, insides together, per marks on patterns and stitch along fold line 1/16 to 1/8 inch from edge.	301	OSf-1	10-12	B	B	
	c. Attach eyelet to the pockets per marks on patterns.						
	d. Thread drawcords thru the eyelet knotting ends. Fold tops of pockets to the inside per marks on patterns forming hem and enclosing drawcord, and stitch 1/8 to 3/16 inch from edge.	301	EFb-1	10-12	B	B	

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TABLE II. (cont'd)

NO.	MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
9.	Assemble crotch protector.						
	a. Position label to face side of crotch protector extension piece centered and 2 to 2-1/2 inches from edge. Stitch on all four sides 1/16 to 3/32 inch from edge.	301	SSa-1	10-12	B	B	
	b. With face sides together and crotch strap between plies per marks on patterns, stitch around sides and strap end of crotch pad.	301	SSa-1	10-12	B	B	
	c. Turn right side out, pushing out corners and insert padding. Turn the seam allowance of the open end in and stitch 1/16 to 1/8 inch from edge tacking ends.	301	SSc-1	10-12	B	B	
	d. Position loose end of crotch strap to crotch protector per marks on pattern and folding the end under stitch in place at least three times across the tape. Label shall be toward wearer.	301	EFd-1	10-12	B	B	
10.	Assemble jacket.						
	a. Overedge stitch around spine pocket and the slide fastener edge of left and right fronts	502, 504, or 505	EFd-1	10-12	B	B	
	b. Position spine protector pocket to the inside of the jacket back per marks on patterns and stitch both sides and bottom 1/8 to 1/16 inch from edge, tacking ends.	301	LSbj-1	10-12	B	B	
	c. With seams towards the back, double lap seam fronts to back at shoulders.	301	LSc-2	10-12	B	B	

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1 Dec 76 EDITION OF 1 OCT 76 WILL BE USED UNTIL EXHAUSTED.

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NO.	TABLE II. (cont'd) MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
10.	Assemble jacket. (cont'd)						
	d. With insides together, seam sleeves to body. Open the panels to lay flat, fold seam into itself, and stitch 1/16 to 1/8 inch from folded edge.	301	LSr-2	10-12	B	B	
	e. Seam underarm/side seam in one continuous seam.	301	LSc-2	10-12	B	B	
	f. Position label to face side of jacket back padding pocket (A) centered and 1 to 2 inches down from top. Stitch on all four sides 1/16 to 3/32 inch from edge.	301	SSa-1	10-12	B	B	
	g. Position shoulder padding pockets, hemmed opening towards back and back padding pockets, A overlapping B, face side op to the inside of the jacket per marks on patterns and turning the unhemmed seam allowances under (except bottom edge of back pocket pieces) and stitch 1/8 to 3/16 inches from folded edge.	301	LSd-2	10-12	B	B	
	hi. Turn sleeve hem to the inside per marks on patterns and stitch 1/16 to 1/8 inch from edge with a double row of stitching spaced 3/8 to 1/2 inch apart.	301	EFb-2	10-12	B	B	
	i. Turn bottom edge of jacket to the inside per marks on patterns and stitch 1/16 to 1/8 inch from folded edge with four rows of stitching spaced 3/16 to 1/4 inch apart.	301	EFb-4	10-12	B	B	

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NO.	MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
10.	Assemble jacket. (cont'd)						
	j. With the seam allowances for the front slide fastener turned to the inside of the jacket, position the collar to the neck opening matching ends. Stitch in place, tacking ends.	301	SSa-1	10-12	B	B	
	k. With neck seam towards the jacket, position neck seam tape over the seam and turning tape ends under stitch both sides and ends of tape 1/16 to 1/8 inch from edge.	301	LSbj-1	10-12	B	B	
	l. With seam allowance turned to the inside, position the right and left slide fastener to the inside of the front panels with bottom edges even, and stitch 1/16 to 1/8 inch from edge double row of stitching spaced 1/4 to 3/16 inch apart.	301	SSt-2	10-12	B	B	
11.	Assemble trousers.						
	a. Overedge stitch the length of both side seams of the trouser legs and both sides and top of crotch extension.	502, 504, or 505	EFD-1	10-12	B	B	
	b. Seam right and left trouser legs together at back seam.	301	LSc-2	10-12	B	B	
	c. Position two seat strap end reinforcement pieces, two stirrup buckle strap reinforcement pieces, and four cargo pocket reinforcement pieces to the inside of the trousers per marks on patterns and stitch on all four sides 1/16 to 1/8 inch from edge.	301	LSbj-1	10-12	B	B	

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TABLE II. (cont'd)

NO.	MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
11.	Assemble trousers. (cont'd)						
	d. Fold seat strap ends over seat strap ring reinforcement pieces, thread each end thru a ring to overlap for 8 inches, and tack together as close to the ring as possible.	301	EFa-1	10-12	B	B	
	e. With the ends of the straps to the under side, position the seat strap to the inside of the trousers per marks on pattern and stitch completely around the strap 1/16 to 1/8 inch from the edges with a 5 inch box "W" stitch pattern over each seat strap end reinforcement.	301	LSbj-1	10-12	B	B	
	f. Position the end of the crotch protector without a strap to the front edge of the seat strap and centered over the seat seam. Stitch 1/16 to 1/8 inch from edge with a double row of stitching superimposed one over the other, tacking the ends.	301	LSbj-1	10-12	B	B	
	g. Position the stirrup strap tunnel to the face side of each leg per marks on patterns and stitch one side in place 1/16 to 1/8 inch from edge. Channel stirrup strap under the tunnel and stitch the other side of tunnel in place 1/16 to 1/8 inch from edge tacking ends.	301	LSbj-1	10-12	B	B	
	h. Thread stirrup buckle straps through the buckles, position buckle strap to the face side of the trousers centered over the buckle strap reinforcement pieces and stitch in place with a 4 inch box "W" stitch pattern 1/16 to 1/8 inch from edge.	301	LSbj-1	10-12	B	B	

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NO.	TABLE II. (cont'd) MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
11.	Assemble trousers. (cont'd)						
	i. Position knee padding pockets to the inside of trousers per marks on patterns (pocket opening towards waist), turn seam allowance under and stitch down the square side and across the bottom up to the stirrup tunnel stitching 1/8 to 3/16 inch from edge, tacking both ends. Continue stitching from the opposite side of the stirrup tunnel stitching (leaving stirrups free for adjustment) to where the cargo pocket stitching will be stitched tacking ends.	301	LSd-1	10-12	B	B	
	j. Take care not to catch the knee padding pocket in this operation. Position cargo pockets to the face side of trousers per marks on patterns, turn seam allowance under and stitch both side seams 1/8 to 3/16 inch from edge, tacking ends. Fold pleats to pocket side seams. Superimpose a 1/2 inch tack over the end of the side seam stitching, continuing across the bottom to tunnel stitching, tack end. Continue stitching from the opposite side of the stirrup tunnel stitching (leaving stirrups free for adjustment) across the pocket bottom and superimposing a 1/2 inch tack over the end of the side seam stitching.	301	LSd-1	10-12	B	B	
	k. Bartack the top of each side seam attaching the cargo pocket and the bottom of the pocket on either side of the stirrup tunnel.	Bartack		42	B	B	

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TABLE II. (cont'd)

NO.	MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
11.	Assemble trousers. (cont'd)						
	l. Position left side of the knee padding pocket per marks on patterns, turn side and bottom seam allowance under and stitch 1/8 to 3/16 inch from edge stopping at the cargo pocket stitching, tacking ends.	301	LSd-1	10-12	B	B	
	m. Seam crotch extension to trouser with seam towards the waist.	301	LSc-2	10-12	B	B	
	n. Turn crotch extension top to the inside per marks on patterns and stitch 1/8 to 1/4 inch from edge.	301	EFa-1	10-12	B	B	
	o. Turn the leg hem allowances to the inside of the trousers and stitch 1/8 to 3/16 inches from folded edge.	301	EFb-1	10-12	B	B	
	p. Turn seam allowance under and position left and right slide fasteners to left and right trouser legs respectfully, closing towards the bottom, and stitch in place 1/16 to 1/8 inch from folded leg edge with a 1/4 inch gage double row of stitching.	301	SSt-2	10-12	B	B	
	q. Position seat padding pocket (part B overlapping part A) face side up to the inside of the trousers per marks on patterns and turning the unhemmed seam allowances under (except top edge to be inclosed in waist hem), stitch 1/8 to 3/16 inches from folded edge and across top.	301	LSd-1	10-12	B	B	
	r. Position the one piece stirrup/crotch strap to the face side of trousers per marks on patterns and stitch both sides of each leg strap 1/16 to 1/8 inch from edges beginning and ending with a 5 inch box "W" stitch pattern on each leg.	301	LSbj-1	10-12	B	B	

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TABLE II. (cont'd)

NO.	MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
11.	Assemble trousers. (cont'd)						
	s. Turn the waist hem allowance to the inside, insert two suspender buckle straps and one suspender slide buckle strap per marks on patterns (laying towards ankles) and stitch 1/8 to 1/16 inch from folded edge, enclosing the ends of the slide fasteners.	301	EFb-2(a)	10-12	B	B	
	t. Turn suspender straps towards the jacket and stitch 1/8 to 3/16 inch from the top of waist hem tacking ends and tacking each suspender strap.	301	EFb-2(a)	10-12	B	B	
	u. Thread elastic webbing through the suspender slide buckle, turn suspender ends over 1-1/2 to 1-3/4 inches and stitch to the ends of the elastic webbing with a 1-1/2 inch box "W" stitch pattern.	301	Efb-1	10-12	B	B	
12.	Clean suit.						
	a. Trim all thread ends to 1/4 inch maximum length.						
	b. Remove all loose threads, spot, stains, shade and size tickets.						
13.	Insert padding and spine protector.						
	Insert padding into all padding pockets and spine protector into spine protector pocket.						

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3.7 Finished measurements. The finished measurements for the suit shall conform to table III.

TABLE III. Finished measurements (in inches)

	Small	Medium	Large	X-Large	Tolerance
Chest 1/	26-3/4	28-3/4	30-3/4	32-3/4	± 1/2
Back length 2/	27-1/4	27-3/4	28-1/4	28-3/4	± 1/2
Collar height 3/	6-7/8	6-7/8	6-7/8	6-3/4	± 1/4
Sleeve inseam 4/	22-3/4	22-3/4	22-3/4	22-3/4	± 1/2
Trouser waist 5/	20	22	24	26	± 1/2
Leg inseam 6/	44	44	44	44	± 1/2

1/ With the jacket front closed and smoothed flat, measure across front from folded edge to folded edge at the base of armhole.

2/ With the jacket smooth and flat, measure from collar/neck seam to the bottom of the jacket hem.

3/ Measure from the neck seam to the top of the collar at the highest point.

4/ Measure the sleeve inseam from the base of armhole along the inseam to bottom of sleeve.

5/ With the front of trousers closed and smoothed flat, measure across waist from folded edge to folded edge.

6/ Measure from the base of crotch along the inseam of leg to the bottom of leg.

3.8 Workmanship. The finished suit shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements, however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

4.1.2 Responsibility for dimensional requirements. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for ensuring that all specified dimensions have been met. When dimensions cannot be examined on the end item, inspection shall be made at any point, or at all points in the manufacturing process necessary to ensure compliance with all dimensional requirements.

4.1.3 Certificate of compliance. When certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to inspect such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 3.1 and 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.2 and 4.4.3.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1.1 Component and material certification. A certificate of compliance may be acceptable as evidence that the padding material (3.3.3), pocket drawcord hardware (3.3.17), stirrup quick release buckle (3.3.18), suspender adjusting buckle (3.3.19), suspender slide buckle (3.3.20), seat strap ring (3.3.21), and the spine protector (3.3.22) conform to the requirements specified.

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4.4.1.2 Component testing. A sample unit consisting of five 4 by 4 inch specimens shall be randomly selected from each lot of padding material regardless of lot size. Each specimen shall be placed on a stationary anvil for testing of the transfer force. The load plate with measuring device (accelerometer) attached shall be adjusted to fall with an impact drop velocity of 10 feet per second. Each specimen shall be tested and results recorded, and retested after 30 seconds with the results again recorded. The results of all individual determinations shall be averaged. An average transfer force greater than 410 G's acting over a 10 millisecond period shall be cause for rejection of the lot represented by the sample.

4.4.2 End item visual examination. The end items shall be examined for the defects listed in table IV. The lot size shall be expressed in units of suits. The sample unit shall be one suit. The inspection level shall be II (see 6.5).

TABLE IV. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Material defects	Hole, cut, tear, or needle chew:		
	Up to 1/8 inch inclusive		201
	- more than 1/8 inch	101	
	Mend, darn, or patch:		
	- more than 1/2 inch		202
	Weakening defects:		
	Smash	102	
	Multiple float or loose slub:		203
	Slub or shade bar:		204
Cleanness	Any spot or stain on outside		205
	Any shade or size marking not removed		206
	Thread ends not trimmed		207
Component and assembly	Any component or required operation omitted (unless otherwise classified herein)	103	
	Any operation not performed as specified (unless otherwise classified herein)		208
Cutting	Any component part not cut in conformance with directional lines indicated on patterns or not in accordance with specification requirements	104	

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TABLE IV. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Seams and stitching	Accuracy of seaming:		
	Seams, twisted, puckered, or pleated		209
	Part of garment caught in unrelated operation or stitching	105	
	Ends of stitching backstitched less than 1/2 inch		210
	Stitching overlapping end(s) of thread break less than 1/2 inch		211
	Ends of a continuous line of stitching overlapped less than 1/2 inch		212
	Stitches broken or missing:		
	- up to 1/2 inch inclusive		213
	- more than 1/2 inch	106	
	Raw edges more than 1/4 inch long		214
	Seam or stitch type not as specified		215
	Stitches per inch more than maximum or less than minimum specified		216
	Loose tension, resulting in a loose seam	107	
Slide fasteners	Defective, affecting function	108	
	Not type, size or style specified		217
Collar	Twisted or puckered		218
Pockets	Not positioned or stitched as specified		219
Padding pockets	One or more pocket piece omitted	109	
	One or more padding piece omitted	110	
	Not stitched as specified		220
Sleeve tabs	One or more tabs omitted	111	
	One or more tabs not as specified seriously affecting function	112	
Leg strap	One or more omitted	113	
	Length of continuous loop not as specified	114	
	Not assembled as specified seriously affecting function	115	
	Not stitched as specified		221

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TABLE IV. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Groin protector	Omitted	116	
	Not stitched as specified		222
	Fastener tape omitted	117	
Shoulder strap	Omitted or not as specified	118	
Labels	Omitted, incorrect, or illegible	119	

4.4.3 End item dimensional examination. The end items shall be examined for conformance to the dimensions specified in table III. Any dimension not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of suits. The sample unit shall be one suit. The inspection level shall be S-3 (see 6.5).

4.4.4 Packaging examination. The fully packaged end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-2 (see 6.5).

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as: incomplete sealing or closure of flap, improper taping, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling Bulged or distorted container
Content	Number per container is more or less than required

4.4.5 Palletization examination. The fully packaged and palletized end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of palletized unit loads. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load, fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-1 (see 6.5).

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Examine	Defect
Finished dimension	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified Interlocking of loads not as specified Load not bonded as specified
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A preservation. Each suit, with pads in place and all fasteners secured, shall be folded to approximate 27 by 15 inches. One folded suit shall be packed in a plastic bag in accordance with A-A-50083.

5.1.2 Commercial preservation. Suits shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four suits of one size only, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 27 inches in length, 15 inches in width, and 26 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.2). Strapping shall be limited to non-metallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four suits of one size only, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. The inside dimensions of each shipping container shall be as specified in 5.2.1. Each container shall be closed in accordance with method III, as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

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5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard container. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping containers shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Suits of one size only, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2) suits, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3 shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Pallet type shall be type I (4-way entry), type IV , or type V in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Pallets shall be fabricated from wood groups I, II, III, or IV of MIL-STD-731. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means C and D or film bonding means F or G. Pallet pattern shall conform to number 3 of the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers, and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The suits are intended for use by military personnel while parachuting into rough terrain.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Size required (see 1.2).
c. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
d. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.3).
e. Levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
f. Type and class of unit load required (see 5.2.1).
g. When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
h. When palletization is required (see 5.3).
i. Acceptance criteria required (see 6.5).

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6.3 First article. When a first article sample is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.4 Samples. For access to the samples, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids or request for proposal.

6.5 Acceptance criteria. The acceptance criteria below are recommended for use. The acceptance criteria as specified in the contract or purchase order shall be binding. Unless otherwise specified, the following acceptance criteria are in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

6.5.1 For end item visual examination. An acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, of 2.5 for major defects and 15.0 for minor defects is recommended.

6.5.2 For end item dimensional examination. An AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, of 4.0 is recommended.

6.5.3 For packaging examination. An AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units of 2.5 is recommended.

6.5.4 For palletization examination. An AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, of 6.5 is recommended.

6.6 Subject term (key word) listing.

Outerwear
Protective clothing

Custodians:
Army - GL
Navy - NU
Air Force - 99

Preparing activity:
Army - GL

(Project 8415-0725)

Review activities:
Army - MD
Air Force - 11, 82
DLA - CT

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-S-44385	Suit, Parachutists, Rough Terrain

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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